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Léa

Léa paced the camp, walking along the edge of the barbed-wire fence. She couldn't stop thinking about Rose and what would happen to her if she remained here. Now that poor Édouard was gone, Virginie would struggle to hold on to the winery. She might not be able to manage it on her own and Rose would have to find another place to live. Rose could always return to her job cleaning the school in the mornings, but the pay wouldn't be enough to cover a room in one of the cheaper boardinghouses. The only way to support Rose was to go to Germany, though it meant Rose would lose her sister, as well as having lost André, the man she was in love with.

Kicking pebbles, she struggled with the choices ahead.

"Just arrived?"

Léa turned. Behind the barbed wire stood a woman with sunken blue eyes. "It's the second time you've gone past this way," she said.

Behind her, a group of women sat on the steps of a barracks smoking and watching Léa.

"Yesterday," she said.

"Oh, that's why you're walking in circles." The woman laughed.

"Maybe," Léa couldn't help but smile. "And you?"

"A week." She looked beyond Léa, straining to see farther. "What's it like on your side?"

Léa shrugged. "Too many people, too few cabins. Not enough toilets. Cold nights." She shifted her feet, stirring dust in the rocky dirt.

"Same as here." She hugged her waist. "That's why I'm getting out."

"They're letting you out?" Léa's voice caught.

The woman looked up, her gaze drifting after a black bird slicing across